

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE FOCUS:

MY REFLECTIONS TODAY ARE CENTERED ON **THRESHOLDS**,
ON THOSE WHO CROSS THE THRESHOLDS OF OUR LIVES.

A Threshold means a doorstep or the entrance or place or point of entering or beginning; usually a strip of wood or stone forming the bottom of a doorway into a house or room.

◆ ON WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES

This subject is something that I have not only noticed in my years of Pastoral work, but I have endeavoured to also practice it in my own life, family, home.

In my years of pastoral work, I have noticed how important this matter is in the lives of all peoples but especially all believers in Christ.

I have also noticed that the failure to address this matter both personally and in the family has seriously affected the quality of life experienced.

THE MESSAGE:

BEING DILIGENT AS TO WHO CROSSES **THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES**.

Examples.

1. **GUARDING OUR HEARTS**

- ◆ THIS MEANS TO BE CAREFUL WHAT WE ALLOW TO ENTER **OUR HEART** – I.E. THAT CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF **OUR HEART**.

Proverbs 4:23-24

23 Guard your heart above all else, for it determines the course of your life. 24 Avoid all perverse talk; stay away from corrupt speech. NLT

PERVERSE means **STUBBORN – HEADSTRONG**.

CORRUPT means **DISHONEST, CROOKED, IMORAL**.

AVOID, means to **STAY AWAY FROM** - i.e. from that kind of talk

- ◆ **DON'T ALLOW **OUR HEART** TO BE EXPOSED TO **THAT KIND OF TALK**.**
- ◆ **DON'T ALLOW PEOPLE TO CROSS THRESHOLD OF YOUR LIFE **WHO TALK OR SPEAK **WRONGLY****.**
- ◆ **SET SOME RULES AS TO WHAT **YOUR HEART** WILL BE **EXPOSED TO**.**

Proverbs 22:17-18

17 Listen to the words of the wise; apply your heart to my instruction.

18 For it is good to keep these sayings in your heart and always ready on your lips. NLT

- ◆ **THIS IS **OUR RESPONSIBILITY** – NOT GOD'S**
- ◆ **WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD, DOORWAY INTO OUR HEARTS; IS IT **THE LISTENING EAR?****

2. **GUARDING THE EAR**

Job 34:3 For the ear tests words as the tongue tastes food. NIV

Job 34:3 Job said, 'The ear tests the words it hears just as the mouth distinguishes between foods.' NLT

- ◆ **Just as we taste food and because it is going to give us “tummy trouble” we reject it from entering our physical body SO **SHOULD THE EAR** be discerning to reject those words, stories, rumours that will harm our lives- affect the attitudes of the heart.**

- ◆ **WHO DO WE ALLOW TO SPEAK INTO OUR LIVES?**
- ◆ **WHAT KIND OF PERSONS DO WE LISTEN TO ARE?**
- ◆ **ARE THEY PEOPLE OF GOOD REPUTATION OR ARE THEY KNOWN FOR BEING COMPLAINERS, DISSENTERS, GOSSIPERS?**
Proverbs 17:4 Wrongdoers eagerly listen to gossip; liars pay close attention to slander. NLT
- ◆ **DO WE ALLOW OUR EARS TO CONTINUALLY LISTEN TO WRONG THINGS OR TO REJOICE IN THE MISFORTUNES OF OTHERS?**
Proverbs 17:5 Those who mock the poor insult their Maker; those who rejoice at the misfortune of others will be punished. NLT
- ◆ **HAVE WE SET SOME CONSTRAINTS ON WHAT OUR EARS HEAR?**
- ◆ **WE SHOULD SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR/THRESHOLD OF OUR EARS.**

3. OUR LIVES

- ◆ **WHO CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES?**
- ◆ **WHO ARE THE PEOPLE THAT ARE A REGULAR PART OF OUR LIFE?**
- ◆ **WHO ARE OUR FRIENDS AND WITH WHOM DO WE 'HANG OUT WITH'?**
 - **What kind of persons are they?**
Psalms 1:1 Oh, the joys of those who do not follow the advice of the wicked, or stand around with sinners, or join in with mockers. NLT
- ◆ **ARE THEY PERSONS OF INTEGRITY, FAITHFULNESS AND HAVE A SERVANT ATTITUDE?**
Proverbs 20:7 The godly walk with integrity; blessed are their children who follow them. NLT
- ◆ **FROM WHOM DO WE RECEIVE ADVICE, COUNSEL AND MENTORING - IS IT YOUR PASTOR / LEADER?**
- ◆ **Counsel from other wise men and women outside our Pastor is good but including counsel from our pastor / leader also shows submission and trust in them.**
Proverbs 15:22 Plans go wrong for lack of advice; many advisers bring success. NLT
Proverbs 20:15 Wise words are more valuable than much gold and many rubies. NLT
Proverbs 11:3 The integrity of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity. NIV
- ◆ **WHAT KIND OF PEOPLE DO WE ATTRACT TO OURSELVES – I.E. the kind of people who like to be with us.**
- ◆ **WHAT BOUNDARIES HAVE WE SET FOR THOSE PASSING OVER THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES?**

4. THE THRESHOLD OF OUR HOMES

- ◆ **WHO DO YOU ALLOW TO COME INTO YOUR HOME?**
- ◆ **Who regularly visits you and 'hangs out' in your home?**
 - **What kind of people are they? – people of integrity & Honesty?**
Psalms 25:21 May integrity and honesty protect me, for I put my hope in you. NLT
- ◆ **WE SHOULD SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR OF OUR HOMES AND NOT ALLOW THOSE PERSONS WHO BRING WRONG THOUGHTS, ABUSIVE LANGUAGE, STRONG DRINK, GOSSIP, REPEATING RUMOURS, OR SPEAKING EVIL OF OTHERS.**
Proverbs 17:9 Whoever covers an offense seeks love, but he who repeats a matter separates close friends. ESV
Proverbs 15:28 The heart of the godly thinks carefully before speaking; the mouth of the wicked overflows with evil words. NLT
- ◆ **WHAT KIND OF TALK DO WE EXPOSE OUR CHILDREN TO AT THE MEAL TABLE?**
 - **Do we talk in front our children the difficulties that we are having in the church or more importantly those who criticise us or the work because children formulate opinions more easily than adults then affects them negatively and they can hold negative feelings against others long after there has been reconciliation and resolve in those strained relationships.**
- ◆ **BE CAREFUL TO SET BOUNDARIES ON WHAT YOU TALK ABOUT IN FRONT OF YOUR CHILDREN.**
- ◆ **WE SHOULD NOT EXPOSE OUR CHILDREN TO THOSE THINGS THAT WILL NEGATIVELY AFFECT THEIR GROWTH IN GOD.**

SET A WATCHMAN AT YOUR THRESHOLDS

Ezekiel 3:17 "Son of dust, I have appointed you as a watchman for Israel; whenever I send my people a warning, pass it on to them at once. TLB

Amen – Ps Barry